



The victory has come at a price. The signs are visible in the new affidavit on Sethusamudram project and Soren's impending induction.

Renuka Chowdhury and Madhu Yaskhi to bring back the lost vote. Audikesavulu managed to defy the party whip and add to the UPA tally of 275.

The victory won't be without a price though. Already the signs are visible. The DMK has extracted a new affidavit in the ongoing Sethusamudram project case throwing up a new controversy on the Ram Sethu. In a few days, Manmohan Singh will have to accommodate Soren and the SP demand sheet is yet to be attended to. Then there is the "notegate" scandal, which the Speaker will have to address. Already the CPI(M) and the BJP have both demanded that the tapes be made public and called for a high-level probe into the charges raised by the three BJP MPs. It is early days yet but the Congress is clearly prepared to pay the political price of this arithmetic victory. After all, in free market economics or politics, there is no gain without attendant risks.

with Shyam Lal Yadav, Stephen David and Anamath K. Menon

PRIZED CATCH:

The Congress was able to wrench out Soren from the NDA's clutches

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